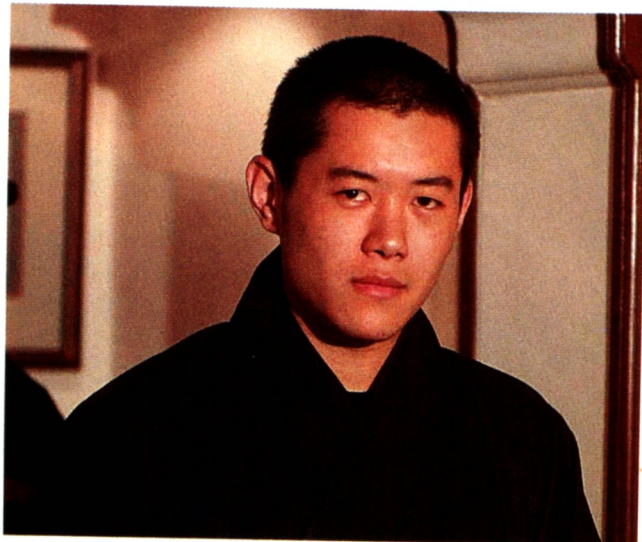


AFP



Bhutan Goes Bollywood

DELHI The coronation of Bhutan's new King Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuk next month will feature a surprisingly varied cast from India. Led by chief guest President Pratibha Patil, a power-packed delegation comprising not merely top political honchos but also Shah Rukh Khan will travel to Thimpu. The Indian delegation will manage a double act of cementing ties with Bhutan and entertaining the new king.

The crowning of Wangchuk, 29, who is world's youngest king, will be a special affair with lots of colour and fanfare. While UPA Chairperson Sonia Gandhi is a special invitee, Congress General Secretary Rahul Gandhi is also expected to be there along with External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee.

Despite the pageantry and the presence of political heavyweights, the show stealer may well turn out to be a performance by Khan

BLUE BLOOD: Wangchuk

and Bollywood's newest heart-throb Katrina Kaif at Thimpu's new soccer stadium. The king is an avid movie watcher and the performance has been planned at his royal request.

Bhutan is the only country in the world that measures its prosperity by what is known as the gross national happiness. In March, the tiny country of 7,00,000, which acts as a strategic buffer for India, took a giant leap to voluntary democracy, a rare feat for a country ruled by a monarch. The present king's father Jigme Singye Wangchuk spearheaded the change.

The Bhutan Peace and Prosperity Party led by Jigme Y. Thinley swept the polls by a landslide margin. While the king is the head of state, the Parliament holds the right to remove him by a two-thirds majority. Also, a retirement age of 60 has been fixed for the monarch, something a not-so-young prince in London has been waiting for long. **by Saurabh Shukla**

SIGNPOSTS

DISMISSED: Major General A.K. Lal, by the army's general court martial, for allegedly molesting a woman officer under his command. This is the first time that a major general has been dismissed. Lal will lose his pension and ex-service-men benefits if the verdict is confirmed by army chief General Deepak Kapoor.



WON: By Saina Nehwal, the Chinese Taipei Open. She is the first Indian woman

shuttler to have won two Grand Prix crowns.

WON: By reigning national squash champion Saurav Ghosal, the inaugural Ornano International Open in Bordeaux, France.

BAGGED: By the Indian Judo team, 12 medals including 11 gold at the South Asian Judo Championship in Kathmandu, Nepal.

VIS-A-VIS L. K. ADVANI Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha **versus** ABHISHEK MANU SINGHVI Congress spokesperson

The UPA Government is spineless and has become a curse for the country. POTA will be restored if the NDA returns to power.



SAURABH SINGH

Advani should have quit when there were terrorist attacks during NDA's rule. How many times did he resign?

EPILOGUE: Instead of blaming each other, parties should come together to fight terror.